

TAMU CAT

Competency Assessment Tracking

Software Overview & User Guide

Prepared for the Master of Health Administration program
Texas A&M University, School of Public Health

What is TAMU CAT?

TAMU CAT (Competency Assessment Tracking) is the software system the MHA program uses to track each student's development against the program's defined professional competencies, from admission through graduation. It replaces the earlier paper- and spreadsheet-based MHA Competency Survey process with a single, auditable system that combines two independent sources of evidence (the student's own self-assessment and course-based grades supplied by faculty) alongside advisor guidance, into one longitudinal record per student.

The system is organized around four competency domains (Health Care Environment and Community, Leadership Skills, Management Skills, and Analytic and Technical Skills), each containing several named competencies (e.g. Policy Analysis, Financial Management, Systems Thinking). Students are assessed against these competencies at defined checkpoints throughout the program (initial, midpoint, and final), across both the Residential and Executive tracks.

Who uses it

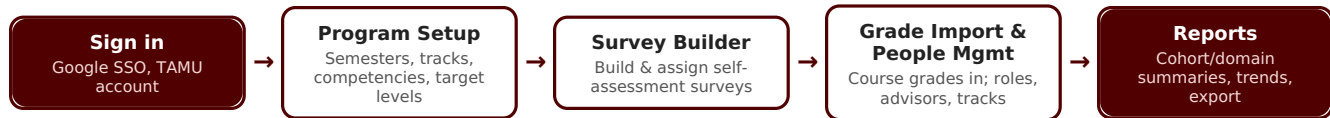
Role	What they do in the system
Admin / Director	Configures the program (semesters, tracks, competencies, surveys), imports course grades supplied by faculty, assigns self-assessment surveys to students, monitors program-wide progress, and generates cohort-level reports for accreditation and program review.
Faculty	Grade coursework in their own gradebook (e.g. Canvas) exactly as they do today, then hand that data to the admin team as an export file. From there, the admin team's Grade Import turns it into structured competency evidence for every graded student. See "The two sources of data" below.
Advisor	Reviews each advisee's self-assessment once complete, alongside the course evidence already on file, provides scored feedback and comments, and records a structured recap after each advising meeting (initial, midpoint, final).
Student	Completes a self-assessment survey at each checkpoint, rating their own progress on every competency, and can review their cumulative progress and download a personal portfolio report at any time.

A note on this document. The remainder of this packet walks through each role's workflow, then shows real example output from the system: a cohort-level report, the two data sources that feed it, what faculty data looks like on the way in, what an advisor sees once a student finishes, and a student's own report. An appendix points to a live demo you can explore yourself.

How each role moves through the system

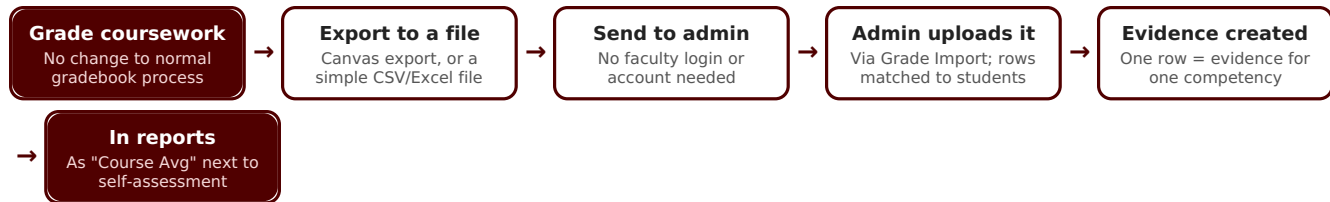
The four diagrams on the following pages summarize each role's actual workflow in TAMU CAT.

Admin / Director



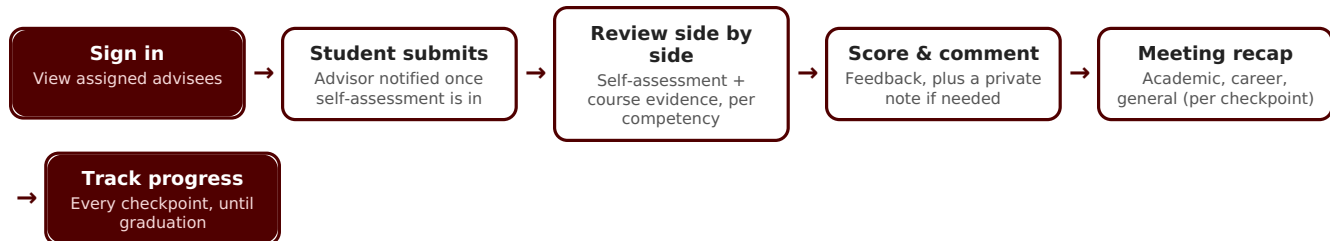
The admin is the only role that touches every part of the system: setup, both data sources, and the reporting layer.

Faculty (via Admin)



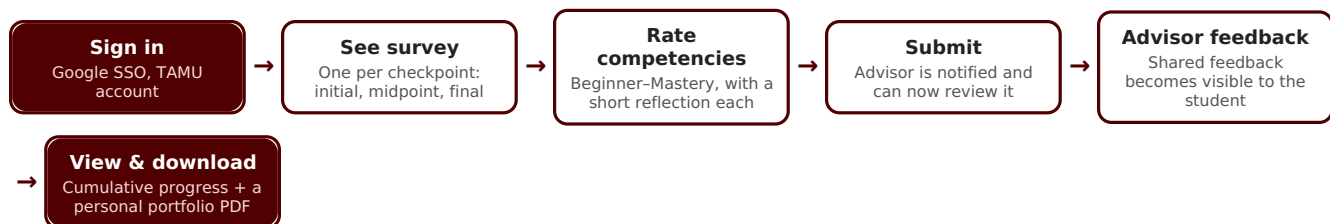
With a single file from faculty, the admin team turns an entire course's grades into competency evidence for every student in it, visible in reports next to each student's own self-assessment, with no new workflow for instructors to learn.

Advisor



Advisors are the only role that sees both data sources and the student directly, side by side, at the individual level.

Student



This is the workflow shown in the example student report later in this packet.

MHA Competency Proficiency Scale

Student achievement on the competencies is assessed using the following scale.

Level 5 (Mastery): Strategic Leader

I am a recognized authority who pioneers solutions to complex, non-routine problems and drives high-level strategic decision-making with total autonomy.

Level 4 (Experienced): Advanced Practitioner

I independently apply specialized theories to solve real-world problems and can articulate complex nuances to guide and mentor others.

Level 3 (Capable): Autonomous Professional

I possess a solid practical grasp of my field, reliably executing standard tasks and contributing to team projects with minimal oversight.

Level 2 (Emerging): Developing Associate

I am building my professional toolkit and can execute foundational tasks, though I require guidance and clear parameters for more complex assignments.

Level 1 (Beginner): Foundational Learner

I am establishing a baseline awareness of core concepts and require structured supervision and mentorship to align my work with professional standards.

0 (Not able to assess)

Used by an advisor when they are not yet able to evaluate the student on a given competency.

Appendix A: Exploring the live demo

A demo instance of TAMU CAT, pre-loaded with the same kind of synthetic data used for the example reports in this packet, is available for hands-on exploration. No real student data is present in the demo environment.

DEMO SITE

<https://mha-demo-b1f5350034f2.herokuapp.com/>

Signing in

The demo uses the same Google-account sign-in as the production system. Ask the program administrator for a demo account, or request temporary access to view the admin, advisor, or student experience.

What to try, by role

- **As an admin:** open *Reports* to generate a cohort summary like the one in this packet, or *Survey Records* → *Grade Import* to see a completed course-data import.
- **As an advisor:** open a completed advisee from your dashboard to see their self-assessment next to course evidence, and try adding feedback or a meeting recap.
- **As a student:** complete a self-assessment survey end to end, then download the resulting portfolio report as a PDF from your dashboard.

Demo data resets periodically. Anything entered in the demo environment (feedback, survey answers, imported files) should be treated as temporary and may be cleared when the demo dataset is refreshed.

Appendix B: Glossary

Term	Meaning
Competency	One of the named professional skills the MHA program tracks (e.g. Policy Analysis, Financial Management). Competencies are grouped into four domains.
Track	Residential or Executive: the two cohort types the program runs, tracked separately throughout the system and in reports.
Checkpoint	Initial, midpoint, or final: the three points in the program when a student completes a self-assessment and meets with their advisor.
Target level	The competency rating (1–5) a course or the program expects a student to reach by a given point. Set by the admin team per course or per program.
Student % Meeting Target / Course % Meeting Target	The two report metrics described in this packet: the share of students who met the target level in their own self-assessment, and the share who met it in the rating derived from imported course grades, for a given competency.
Grade import batch	One admin-initiated upload of a faculty course-grade file. TAMU CAT parses it into row-level competency evidence, which the admin reviews before it becomes reportable.
Meeting recap	A structured note an advisor records after each advising meeting, covering academic advising, career advising, and general support needs.
Composite report	The PDF a student (or their advisor) can generate at any time, combining the student's self-assessment answers with any shared advisor feedback.